

High-chance portions — culture-perf

Combined original study articles for this topic's highest-probability PYQ themes.

Classical Dance & Music Traditions

~28% · [Classical dances](#) · [Music schools](#) · [Instruments](#)

Recognized classical dances and Hindustani/Carnatic basics.

Why UPSC asks this

Intermittent but syllabus-important matching questions.

Dance

State/region association + one distinctive feature (storytelling style, costume, music).

Music

Raga/tala idea; gharanas at light touch; folk vs classical boundary questions.

Must remember

- Bharatanatyam, Kathak, Kathakali, Odissi, Kuchipudi, Sattriya, Manipuri, Mohiniyattam
- Hindustani vs Carnatic high-level contrast